The Noble Dhāraṇī of the Rite of the Heart of Dependent Origination

Āryapratītyasamutpādahṛdayavidhidhāraṇī · Toh 979 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་རྟེན་ཅིང་འབྲེལ་བར་འབྱུང་བའི་སྙིང་པོའི་ཆོ་གའི་གཟུངས།

The Noble Dhāraṇī of the Rite of the Heart of Dependent Origination, known in Sanskrit as the Āryapratītyasamutpādahṛdayavidhidhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Phakpa Tenching Drelwar Jungwé Nyingpö Choga Zung, is a short ritual text built around the famous verse summarizing the Buddha's teaching on dependent origination. After paying homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas, it recites the verse "Those phenomena that arise from causes," which the Great Śramaṇa proclaimed, and then presents a rite for putting these words into practice for the benefit of beings and the accomplishment of every kind of activity. It frames this practice for those who have first developed reverence and faith toward the Buddha, and it describes the procedure as a profound rite taught by the Tathāgata himself. The work is Toh 979 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the class of dhāraṇī texts, the collections of incantations and associated ritual instructions.

In the language of India: ārya bratītyasamutpāda hṛdaya bidhi dhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dhāraṇī of the Rite of the Heart of Dependent Origination.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Those phenomena that arise from causes,
and their cessation from causes:
these the Tathāgata has proclaimed.
So spoke the Great Śramaṇa.

The rite for accomplishing these words,
which brings benefit to sentient beings,
in order to accomplish all activities,
the Tathāgata has fully taught.

Sons of good family, whoever
first toward the Blessed Buddha
has given rise to a mind of reverence and faith:
the Blessed One declared,
"I shall explain the profound rite of dependent origination,"
and taught it as suited to every activity.

First he spoke the words of entry:

Thus, if karma and afflictions are present,
sentient beings will wander in saṃsāra;
if karma and afflictions are absent, they turn back even from saṃsāra.
By this truth, may my aspiration be fulfilled!

Homage to the Buddha. Homage to the Dharma. Homage to the Saṅgha. Homage to the perfectly complete buddhas, who dwell as numerous as the sands of the river Ganges. Homage to the pratyekabuddhas. Homage to the arhats. Homage to the non-returners. Homage to the once-returners. Homage to the stream-enterers. Homage to the bodhisattvas, the noble Maitreya and the others. Homage to those who have accomplished their vows. Homage to the physicians of sentient beings. Homage to those who have accomplished the jewel. It is as follows:

namo ratnatrayāya oṃ ye dharmā hetupra bha bā hetu na teṣāṃ tathāgato hya badata teṣāñca yo nirodha ebaṃ bādī mahāśramaṇaḥ svāhā

For the rites of all the activities,
recite these verses.
In one's mind, on the palm of one's own hand,
the body of the Buddha, the Blessed One,
adorned with the marks of a great being,
ornamented with the eighty excellent minor marks,
is to be visualized as dwelling in the element of fire.
Now recollect the deities.

Now I shall explain the applied rites,
teaching each separately in its order.
For sickness from being struck by epidemic fever,
for headache and for eye disease,
for internal disease and other illnesses,
recite this verse and this heart mantra
many times, then stand up,
and with the fist of the right hand
one should sweep, as a means of expelling.
All the illnesses will be cured.

For fevers of one day, two days, three days,
four days, and chronic fevers,

on a white thread spun by a young girl,
twisted threefold,
recite the recitation twenty-eight times;
if it is tied at the neck, one will live in health.
Over medicines that benefit illness,
recite these dhāraṇī-mantras and administer them.

For heart disease, pain in the sides of the ribs,
and whatever internal illnesses there may be,
recite this mantra many times over water;
if it is given to drink, it helps, and one becomes well.
Over medicines that benefit illness,
if one recites and administers them, the sick will be healed.

For itching and for pustules,
for blisters and for sores,
recite this heart mantra many times
over earth from an anthill; if applied, they are healed.
For hemorrhoids, anal disease, and fistula,
and for a swollen and painful penis,
over a pill of barberry and sugar,
or over a bodhisattva pill,
recite twenty times; if it is anointed, it helps.

Whatever the type of illness,
assess whether its severity is great or slight,
and match the recitation of the verse,
more or fewer times, to the illness;
sweeping the body while reciting will help.
For diarrhea that has struck a vital point,
over medicine, pills, or food,
recite seven or twenty times,
and if it is taken internally, it will help.

Its recitation is the former one;
these should be recited thoroughly:

namo ratnatrayāya oṃ ye ṅharmā hetu pra bha bā hetu na teṇī tathāgato hya badatā teṣā ñca ya na ratna aṃ baṃ bādī mahāśramaṇaḥ sāhā

If these are recited, illnesses are healed.
That is the healing of illnesses.

Then again he declared:
Barley and wheat and beans,
rice, lentils, and peas,
fruit, grapes, and myrobalan:
for the insects, beetles, and moths,
the birds, mice, and parrots
that eat all of these,
if one would bind the mouths of those that eat the crops,
in proportion to the extent of the field,
over sand, earth, and ash
recite the recitation one hundred and eight times;
if it is scattered over the fields and fruit trees,
the mouths of all of them will be bound.

When the rain is far too heavy,
over each of the flowers and medicinal herbs
offered to the Blessed One
perform the recitation twenty-one times.
In clean and pleasant places,
in the center of a great maṇḍala,
upon a full vase,
inside a clean bowl,
if those clean flowers that have been recited over
are burned, the rain will cease.

When a violent hailstorm comes,
over branches of rose and of fish-eye willow
recite the recitation one hundred and eight times;
facing the direction from which the hail is coming,
if one whirls them above the head and waves them, it will cease.
Or else, over great ash and white mustard seed
perform the recitation one hundred and eight times,
make a bundle, tie it to a willow branch,
and if it is planted, the hail will cease.

For one seized by bhūtas, piśācas, pretas,
or the graha that causes forgetting (apasmāra),

in a maṇḍala one fathom square
set out five clean vases,
fumigate with the smoke of guggulu,
and mixing medicines such as white mustard seed,
camphor, sandalwood, and musk,
recite the recitation one hundred and eight times.
Provide white clothing and food,
place the person inside that maṇḍala,
and wash them with the water of the vases.
With water that has bathed the Buddha's image,
if one washes them and gives it to drink, it will be of great benefit.
They will be freed from all illnesses and harms,
and bhūtas, apasmāras, and piśācas
will find no opportunity against them.

For a child terrified by grahas,
recite the mantra over bezoar,
write this heart mantra of great power, and tie it on:

oṃ bajra krodha mahābala hana daha paca bidhvansaya jaṭiloṃ bhodhara ucchuṣma krodha hūṃ phaṭ svāhā

Having made it clean, tie it at the neck.
Likewise, over white mustard seed as well,
perform the recitation, wrap it up, and tie it on.
When one is seized by the graha of a ḍākinī,
over white mustard seed and guggulu
recite the two mantras seven times each;
if one fumigates with the smoke, the person will be healed.
Of this there is no doubt.

The child will be freed from grahas and from illness.
When a woman's childbirth is obstructed,
recite the mantra over water five or seven times;
if she is given it to drink, she will give birth safely.
For a barren woman who has no child,
take water that has been used to bathe an image of the Buddha
and recite the mantra over it twenty times.
When she has bathed and her body is clean,

if she is given that water to drink, she will have children,
and her family line will flourish.
When setting out on a journey,
on a thread or on the corner of one's garment
recite the mantra seven times and tie seven knots.
If one sets out having tied and recited,
one travels safely and one's aim is accomplished;
one goes without enemies or harm.
When one wishes one's mind to be retentive,
take sweet flag about a finger-joint in length
and three hundred and sixty measures of ghee,
recite the mantra over them, mix them together,
pour them into a single vessel and stir.
Every day for one year,
a single piece of sweet flag
and a single measure of ghee,
reciting the mantra once over each, one should eat.
By this the mind becomes retentive and one gains intelligence.
Likewise, over the butter and milk
of a tawny cow as well,
recite the mantra a hundred and eight times,
stir it into a milk porridge and eat it;
one will become supreme among those of retentive mind.
If one wishes to associate with people and win their friendship,
take whatever is pleasing to the mind,
flowers, or grass or wood,
or fruit, or clay,
place it in the fist of the right hand,
and recite the mantra over it a hundred and one times.
Whoever's hand one gives it into,
with that person one will always be friends.
When livestock of every kind, horses and the rest,
are lying close to death,
over water together with white mustard seed
recite the mantra a hundred and eight times;
if one sprinkles them with it, they will recover.
Or else, over white mustard seed, a hundred and eight times,

recite, and tie the bundle at the animal's neck;
by this it will be free of illness and well.
When people are terrified of death,
recite the mantra over white mustard seed,
make it into a bundle and hang it at the door.
Recite the mantra a hundred, a thousand, even a hundred thousand times;
all diseases of people and all diseases of livestock
will not even have a name, and there will be well-being.
The recitation for all of these
has been taught at length in all these rites:

namo ratnatrayāya oṃ ye dharmā hetuprabhavā hetunteṣāṃ tathāgato hyavadata teṣāñca yo nirodha evaṃ vādī mahāśramaṇaḥ svāhā

If one recites it constantly,
one's wishes will be completely fulfilled.
No harm whatsoever will take hold,
and one will fully uphold the true Dharma.
These verses
have inconceivable power and miraculous potency.
All these rites,
for whoever trusts in them with faith,
will succeed without any doubt.
If one completes a hundred thousand recitations,
every need will be accomplished.
This compassion of the Teacher Śākyamuni
was found by the monk Nerban Rakṣita
in the land of Tukhāra,
and it has dawned as the glory of all beings.

The Noble Dhāraṇī of the Rite of the Heart of Dependent Origination is complete.

Translator's Notes

• The opening verse is given as the Tibetan has it, which differs slightly from the usual wording of the verse of dependent origination. The plant called "fish-eye" (nya mig), paired with willow, is not securely identified and has been rendered as a variety of willow. The pill of "skyer pa'i khaṇḍa" is taken as barberry with sugar (khaṇḍa); the "bodhisattva pill" is translated literally.
• "Five or seven times" renders □□□□□□□, which could also be read as thirty-five. The monk's name □□□□□□□□□□□□□ is given as spelled; it may stand for Nirvāṇarakṣita, but this cannot be

confirmed. □□□□□ is taken as Tukhāra (Tokharistan). "Measures" renders □□□, a Tibetan unit of weight. "Sweet flag" renders □□□□□ (calamus, Skt. vacā), traditionally used to strengthen memory. The closing syllable after "complete" is a scribal flourish and is not translated.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.